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WORLD OF FOOTBALL

NO MIRACLES, NO MERCY

Bayern Munich halted Real Madrid's comeback script while Atletico Madrid punished Barcelona to seal a **brutal** double exit in the Champions League.

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Over the years, many teams have crumbled against Real Madrid in the knockout stages of the UEFA Champions League despite holding an advantage at some point across the two legs. From Manchester City in the 2021-22 semifinal to Bayern Munich at the same stage two seasons

later, the record-winner of the competition has managed to claw its way out of precarious positions in a way not many sides can.

And for a long time in their quarterfinal second leg against Bayern in the ongoing campaign, Los Blancos looked likely to pull off the inevitable. Trailing by one goal at kick-off in Munich, Real Madrid erased the deficit in just 35 seconds, with Arda Guler capitalising on Manuel Neuer's error with a long-range effort into an empty net.

That set the tie in motion.

An early setback might have rattled many teams, but Vincent Kompany's men stood firm and, within five minutes, regained their advantage through Aleksandar Pavlovic's close-range header. With parity restored, Guler put on the saviour cape once more and

Thriller alert:

Michael Olise celebrates after scoring Bayern Munich's fourth goal, sealing Real Madrid's fate.

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